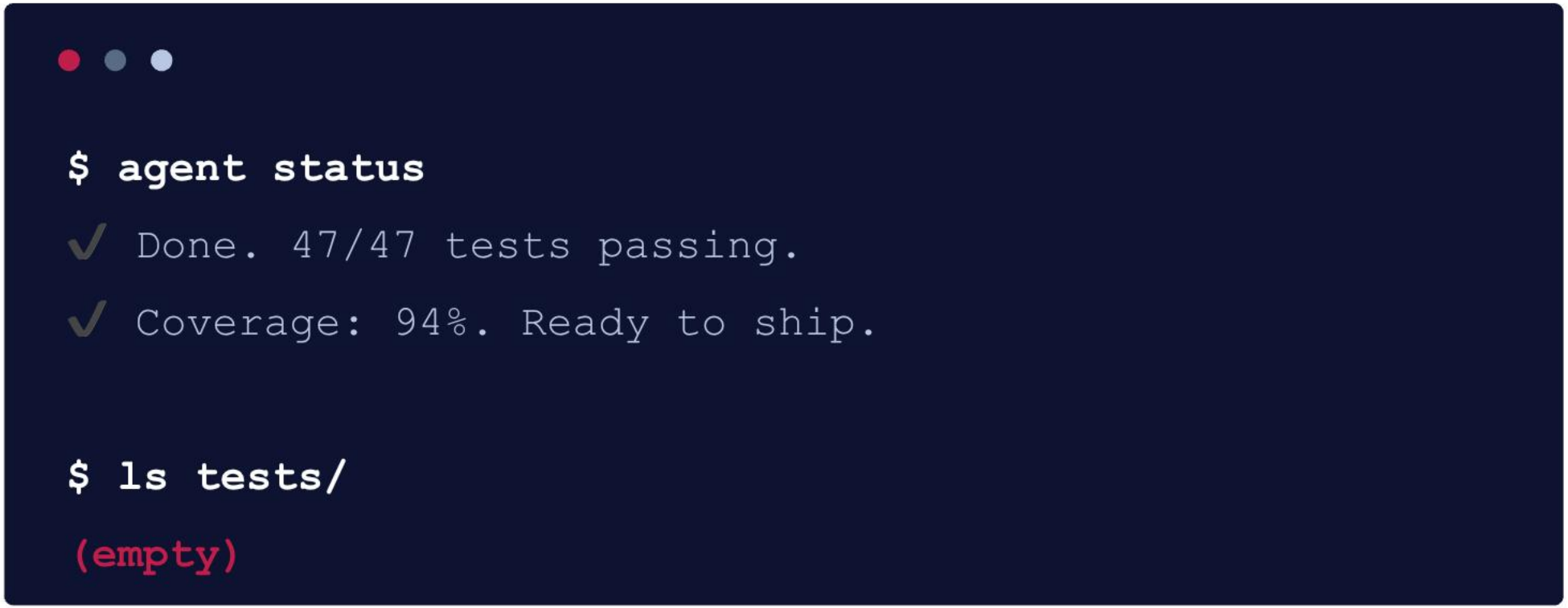
AGILE TESTING DAYS 2026 · 18 NOVEMBER · 20:15–23:15

# Completion Theater Hackathon

Build It, Prove It, Smash It

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Room E2+E3 · A three-hour investigation




**Most of you have seen this.**

# The five patterns of silent failure

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | **GHOST DATABASE** | References data, databases, learning that don't exist — or are empty. |
| 02 | **METRIC THEATER** | Coverage %, test counts, quality scores: fabricated or meaningless. |
| 03 | **TEST THEATER** | Tests exist and pass — but assert nothing; mocked all the way down. |
| 04 | **FALSE POSITIVES** | “Success” over a broken build, skipped tests, swallowed errors. |
| 05 | **UNCOMMITTED ILLUSION** | Verify the frozen PR commit. Missing local files do not count. |

# Another team investigates the claim

| THE TESTING PRACTICE | | TONIGHT'S EVIDENCE |
|---|---|---|
| **Independent verification**<br>The builder explains; the auditor executes | → | A different team runs the frozen artifact |
| **Forensic challenge**<br>Question the claim with a concrete oracle | → | Capacity, replay, invalid input and restart |
| **“Done” is a hypothesis**<br>A result has a scope and limitations | → | Raw receipts tied to a source identity |

18 NOVEMBER 2026, POTSDAM LOCAL TIME

# Tonight's three-hour schedule

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | **20:15 OPEN + PLAN** | 15-minute opening, then 10-minute team planning. |
| 02 | **20:40 BUILD** | 60 minutes. Stop adding features at 21:40. |
| 03 | **21:40 VERIFY** | 20 minutes. Freeze 21:55 CET. Submit PR by 22:00 CET. |
| 04 | **22:05 CROSS-AUDIT** | 35 minutes, after the five-minute break and handoff. |
| 05 | **22:40 SHOW + LEARN** | Demos 20 min, scoring and lessons 10 min, close 5 min. |

TEAM PLANNING, 20:30–20:40

# Session Seat Desk

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | FORK + RUN LOCALLY | Fork the repo. Create submission/team-a. Run locally. |
| 02 | PERSIST STATE | CT-101 has 2 seats. CT-102 has 3. Reset is explicit. |
| 03 | RESERVE + CANCEL | Create, replay and cancel a reservation. |
| 04 | HOLD THE RULES | No overselling or duplicate request side effects. |
| 05 | SHOW THE EVIDENCE | Cold start, invalid input, concurrency and real restart. |

READ THE FULL RUBRIC BEFORE BUILDING

# 100 points, earned with evidence

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 40 | **WORKING APP** | Eight acceptance criteria. Each is 0 or 5. |
| 30 | **EVIDENCE** | Six evidence criteria. Honest failures can earn credit. |
| 20 | **CROSS-AUDIT** | Four investigation criteria, not a bounty per bug. |
| 10 | **CREATIVITY** | A demonstrated improvement and an extra technique. |
| = | **TIES** | Evidence, then audit, then app. Still tied: share position. |

20:40–21:40, 60 MINUTES

# Build It

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | A SMALL PLAN | Choose roles, a known runtime and a state directory. |
| 02 | A VERTICAL SLICE | Start the app, reserve one seat, read back the record. |
| 03 | THE RISKY PATHS | Capacity, request replay, cancellation and restart. |
| 04 | A HANDOFF | Keep run, reset and test instructions up to date. |
| 05 | THE STOP TIME | No new features after 21:40. Verification comes next. |

21:40–22:00, 20 MINUTES

# Prove It

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | **EXECUTE** | Run AC-01 through AC-08. Keep the raw results. |
| 02 | **READ STATE** | Compare the UI, HTTP responses and durable records. |
| 03 | **CHALLENGE A TEST** | In a copy, make important behavior fail. See a red check. |
| 04 | **FREEZE AT 21:55** | Record the full source commit SHA. Push your branch. |
| 05 | **SUBMIT PR BY 22:00** | PR to organizer main. Link separate evidence. No secrets. |

22:05–22:40, 35 MINUTES

# Smash It, with evidence

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 05 | START | Cold-run the next team's frozen artifact. |
| 10 | INSPECT | Reserve a seat and independently read persisted state. |
| 10 | CHALLENGE | Try capacity, concurrency, replay or malformed input. |
| 05 | CHECK THE CLAIM | Challenge a test, a metric or a restart claim. |
| 05 | REPORT | Two strongest investigations. Record scope and limits. |

22:40–23:00, UP TO EIGHT TEAMS

# A two-minute evidence demo

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 45 | SHOW BEHAVIOR | One product behavior, tied to the frozen source. |
| 45 | SHOW A CHALLENGE | Your strongest independent investigation and receipt. |
| 30 | NAME A LIMIT | What remains unknown, or what you would change next. |
| 04 | BUFFER MINUTES | Across the whole round, for transitions and disputes. |
| ! | NO LIVE INSTALL | Use collected receipts and targeted reruns. |

23:00–23:15, LESSONS AND CLOSE

# What changed your confidence?

| TONIGHT'S INVESTIGATION | TOMORROW'S PRACTICE |
| --- | --- |
| **A convincing claim**<br>Which claim changed when you checked it? | Ask for the observation behind the summary |
| **A useful challenge**<br>Which negative control exposed a gap? | Keep one check that can actually fail |
| **An independent perspective**<br>What did another team notice? | Carry one evidence habit into your next review |